

Strengthening Disability-Inclusive Sexual and Reproductive Health Services in Kwale County

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Kwale County has demonstrated its commitment to equity and inclusion through the Kwale Gender and Social Inclusion Policy (2024), which recognizes persons with disabilities as a priority population and commits the County Government to promoting accessible SRHR services. Kwale County has made significant strides in developing the 2024 Kwale with Disability Act, 2024’s better governance and mainstreaming a gender lens in policies and development. The Persons with Disabilities Act, 2025 further strengthens this commitment by guaranteeing persons with disabilities the right to accessible, equal and non-discriminatory healthcare, including sexual and reproductive health (SRHR) services.

Despite these commitments, many persons with disabilities continue to experience barriers when accessing SRHR services. Health facilities remain physically inaccessible; disability-inclusive health information is limited; healthcare workers often lack the skills to provide inclusive care; and partners with disabilities are rarely involved in planning and monitoring SRHR programmes. The priority for Kwale County is therefore to implement existing commitments through practical actions that make SRHR services accessible to all.



WHY THIS MATTERS

Persons with disabilities have the same sexual and reproductive health needs as everyone else. They require access to:

Priority Areas	Priority Action
Family planning information and services	
Maternal and newborn healthcare	
HIV prevention, testing and treatment	
Cervical and breast cancer screening	
Adolescent sexual and reproductive health services	
Sexual violence prevention and response services	

However, barriers to accessibility, stigma and discrimination limit their health, dignity, and rights. Therefore, investing in disability-inclusive SRHR services will help Kwale County improve equitable access to healthcare and ensure no one is left behind.

Priority Advocacy Actions for Kwale County

PRIORITY AREA	LEAD INSTITUTION	RECOMMENDED ACTIONS	EXPECTED SRHR OUTCOME
Increase accessibility of SRHR services	Department of Health, Department of Public Works, Facility Management Teams	Rehabilitate health facilities with ramps, accessible toilets, adaptable examination couches, sober signage, and accessible waiting areas. Redesign maternity wards, family planning rooms, HIV clinics and GBV response spaces.	Persons with disabilities can independently access SRHR services safely and with dignity.
Strengthen disability-inclusive communication	Department of Health, Media Practitioners Unit	Produce SRHR information in Braille, large print, audio, Easy Read and pictorial formats. Expand access in Kenyan Sign Language interpretation in health settings.	Persons with disabilities receive accurate information and make informed decisions about their sexual and reproductive health.
Build the capacity of healthcare providers	Department of Health, CMIT Professional Training Institutions	Integrate disability-inclusive SRHR into continuous professional education. Train providers on respectful care, communication, reasonable accommodation, and disability-inclusive GBV response.	Reduced stigma and discrimination and improved quality of SRHR services for persons with disabilities.
Strengthen disability-inclusive planning and budgeting	County Treasury, County Assembly, Department of Health	Establish dedicated budget lines within the disability inclusive SRHR intervention, including accessible facility infrastructure and assistive technologies, outreach and provider training.	Sustainable financing for disability-inclusive SRHR services.
Promote meaningful participation	Department of Social Services, Department of Health, Organizations of Persons with Disabilities	Ensure persons with disabilities and OPDs participate in county health planning, budgeting, guide development and monitoring of SRHR programmes.	County SRHR programmes better reflect the priorities and lived experiences of persons with disabilities.
Strengthen monitoring and accountability	CMIT, Health Monitoring Unit, Monitoring & Evaluation Unit	Collect and report SRHR data disaggregated by sex, age and disability. Include disability indicators in county health performance reviews.	Better evidence for planning, resource allocation and monitoring equitable access to SRHR services.

Kwale County has already committed to inclusion. The next step is implementation to ensure that persons with disabilities are able to access quality sexual and reproductive health services with dignity, respect and without discrimination.

